

Academic Regulations — Part IV: Attendance

School of Technology · Office of the Dean (Academics) Document ref.: AR/IV/2026 · **Effective from:** Academic Year 2026-27 (Odd Semester, 16 June 2026) · **Supersedes:** AR/IV/2024

1. Purpose and scope

1.1 These regulations govern the recording of attendance, the minimum attendance required for admission to end-semester examinations, and the procedure for condonation of shortfalls, for all students enrolled in undergraduate programmes of the School of Technology.

1.2 They apply to every course offering in which a student is enrolled with status *enrolled* — theory courses, laboratory courses and tutorials alike — and to every semester of the programme.

1.3 Where a course is offered jointly by two departments, the department of the faculty member recorded as the course instructor administers attendance for that offering.

1.4 Nothing in this Part reduces a student's obligation under the Examination and Evaluation Regulations (Part V) or the Student Leave Policy (SL/2026), which are to be read together with this Part.

2. Definitions

2.1 **Session** — one scheduled meeting of a course offering as it appears in the published timetable: a lecture period, a tutorial period or a laboratory block. A two-period laboratory block is one session.

2.2 **Session held** — a session for which the course instructor has recorded attendance. Sessions cancelled by the instructor, sessions falling on notified holidays or during notified breaks, and sessions for which no attendance was recorded are not sessions held.

2.3 **Attended** — a session in which the student is recorded as *present* or *excused leave*. A student recorded as *late* or *absent* is not treated as having attended that session.

2.4 **Attendance percentage** — for a given course offering, the number of sessions attended divided by the number of sessions held, multiplied by one hundred, rounded to one decimal place.

2.5 **Eligibility threshold** — the minimum attendance percentage required under clause 4.2 for admission to the end-semester examination in a course.

2.6 **Condonation** — a written decision by the Head of Department, under clause 5, permitting a student whose attendance is below the eligibility threshold to appear for the end-semester examination.

3. Recording of attendance

3.1 Attendance is recorded by the course instructor for each session held, on the same day, through the University attendance system. Each enrolled student is marked with exactly one of the four statuses: *present*, *absent*, *late* or *excused leave*.

3.2 A student who arrives more than ten minutes after the scheduled start of a session may be marked *late*. A student who arrives after half the scheduled duration has elapsed, or who leaves before the session ends without the instructor's permission, shall be marked *absent*.

3.3 Attendance recorded in the system is final for the purpose of these regulations. An instructor may correct an entry within seven calendar days of the session; corrections after that period require the written approval of the Head of Department.

3.4 The University attendance system publishes each student's attendance percentage for every enrolled course on the student portal. The figure shown on the portal is computed exactly as in clause 2.4 and is the figure used for eligibility under clause 4.

3.5 A student who believes an entry is incorrect must raise it with the course instructor within seven calendar days of the session concerned. Objections raised later than this will not be entertained except where the student was hospitalised for the whole of that period.

3.6 Proxy attendance — answering for, signing for, or otherwise causing another student to be recorded as present — is an act of academic misconduct for both students involved and is dealt with under Part VII (Discipline). Both students are marked *absent* for the session in question.

4. Minimum attendance for examination eligibility

4.1 Attendance is assessed separately for every course offering. A shortfall in one course does not affect eligibility in another.

4.2 A student must have an attendance percentage of at least 75 (seventy-five) per cent in a course offering to be eligible to appear for the end-semester examination in that course.

Eligibility is determined on the last teaching day of the semester as published in the Academic Calendar (6 November 2026 for the Odd Semester 2026-27).

4.3 A student whose attendance in a course is below 75 per cent on the eligibility date shall not be admitted to the end-semester examination in that course unless a condonation has been granted under clause 5.

4.4 Sessions for which the student holds an approved leave request under the Student Leave Policy (SL/2026) are recorded as *excused leave* and, by clause 2.3, count as attended. Absence without an approved leave request counts as absent whatever the reason, until and unless the leave is regularised under SL/2026 clause 6.

4.5 A student who is not admitted to an end-semester examination under clause 4.3 is recorded as **detained** in that course. A detained student receives the grade *F* for the course, must re-register for it in a subsequent semester in which it is offered, and must satisfy the attendance requirement afresh. Internal assessment marks are not carried forward to the re-registration.

4.6 Attendance requirements apply to laboratory courses in the same way as to theory courses. Because laboratory courses typically have fewer sessions in a semester, students should note that each missed laboratory block has a larger effect on the percentage.

4.7 Attendance warnings. The University attendance system issues an automatic warning on the student portal, with a copy to the student's registered e-mail, whenever a student's attendance in any course falls below 80 per cent after the fourth teaching week. The warning is informational; the absence of a warning does not excuse a shortfall.

5. Condonation of shortfall

5.1 The Head of the Department offering the course may condone a shortfall in attendance and admit the student to the end-semester examination, subject to the limits in clauses 5.2 to 5.4.

5.2 Condonation may be granted only where the student's attendance in the course is at least 65 (sixty-five) per cent. A student whose attendance is below 65 per cent in a course is not eligible for condonation on any ground and is detained under clause 4.5.

5.3 Condonation may be granted only on one or more of the following grounds, each of which must be supported by documents submitted with the application:

5.3.1 Medical grounds — illness or injury requiring hospitalisation, or a period of rest of three or

more consecutive days certified by a registered medical practitioner. The certificate must state the period of incapacity and must be issued within the period of illness or within seven days of its end.

5.3.2 Representation of the University — participation in sports, cultural, technical or academic events (including inter-collegiate competitions and hackathons) as an official representative of the University, certified by the Dean of Student Affairs or the faculty coordinator of the event.

5.3.3 Bereavement — death of a member of the immediate family (parent, sibling, spouse, child, grandparent), with documentary evidence.

5.3.4 Other exceptional circumstances — any other circumstance beyond the student's control, which the Head of Department, recording reasons in writing, considers comparable in gravity to the grounds above.

5.4 A student may be granted condonation in not more than two courses in a semester, and in not more than four courses across the whole programme. A shortfall for which condonation has been refused, or which arises in a course in which the student has already been condoned in a previous registration, cannot be condoned.

5.5 Procedure. The student applies for condonation on the prescribed form through the student portal, attaching the supporting documents, and submits it to the Head of Department. The application must be received **before the close of the end-semester examination form submission window** published in the Academic Calendar (for the Odd Semester 2026-27, the window is 12 to 20 October 2026). Applications received after the window closes are not considered.

5.6 The Head of Department decides each application within five working days of receipt and records the decision in the University attendance system. The student is informed through the portal. A student whose application is refused may appeal in writing to the Dean (Academics) within three working days; the Dean's decision is final.

5.7 Condonation admits the student to the end-semester examination only. It does not alter the recorded attendance percentage, and it is not a defence in any subsequent proceeding under Part VII.

6. Worked illustration

6.1 A student enrolled in a theory course in which 50 sessions have been held, and who is recorded as *present* or *excused leave* in 34 of them, has an attendance percentage of 68.0. The student is below the 75 per cent threshold in clause 4.2 by seven percentage points and is therefore not eligible for the end-semester examination in that course under clause 4.3.

6.2 Because the student's attendance is at or above 65 per cent, the student may apply for condonation under clause 5 if one of the grounds in clause 5.3 applies, and must do so before the examination form window closes under clause 5.5. If no ground applies, or the application is refused, the student is detained in the course under clause 4.5.

6.3 To reach 75 per cent without condonation, the student in clause 6.1 would need to attend every one of the next 14 sessions held in that course (48 of 64 is 75.0 per cent). Students are advised to consult the attendance figure on the portal early in the semester rather than at the eligibility date.

7. Responsibilities

7.1 Students are responsible for monitoring their own attendance on the student portal and for applying for leave in advance under SL/2026 wherever possible.

7.2 Course instructors are responsible for recording attendance for every session held, on the day, and for responding to objections under clause 3.5 within seven days.

7.3 **Heads of Department** are responsible for deciding condonation applications within the period in clause 5.6 and for publishing, before the examination form window opens, the list of students in each course who are below the threshold.

7.4 **The Office of the Dean (Academics)** is responsible for issuing hall tickets only to students eligible under this Part, and for hearing appeals under clause 5.6.

8. Transitional provisions and review

8.1 Attendance recorded before 16 June 2026 under AR/IV/2024 is not affected by these regulations.

8.2 The Academic Council reviews this Part every two years. Proposals for amendment may be made to the Dean (Academics) by any department or by the Students' Council.